

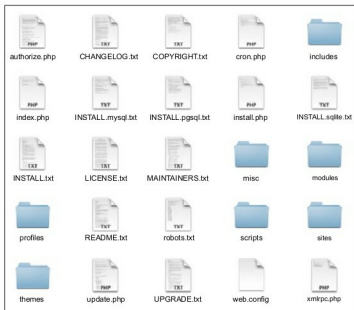


Figure 1: Drupal directory structure

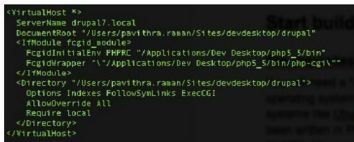


Figure 2: Virtual host config

Music Group uses Drupal to power its artists' websites, while fashion brand Lush uses Drupal for its e-retail store *lushco.uk*. The Weather Channel at NBC is also powered by Drupal... and the list is long.

To check out case studies, you can visit <https://www.drupal.org/case-studies> and <http://www.drupalshowcase.com/>

Start building your own website

So let's learn how to install and get started with a Drupal site, and add some basic content to it. A basic knowledge about using computers and how to install software on them is required. Experience in working on a LAMP, WAMP or MAMP stack is preferable.

Prerequisites

You will need a *AMP stack, which implies a computer, laptop or server with a stable operating system like Windows, Mac OS, UNIX or any Linux based OS like Ubuntu, Fedora, Red Hat, etc. Note that PHP is a requirement since Drupal has been written in it. PHP 5.4 or higher is recommended. Usually, the database used is MySQL. However, other databases like PostgreSQL, SQLite, MS SQL server or Oracle can be chosen. We need a Web server, which could be Apache, Nginx, or Microsoft IIS. Apache is usually chosen.

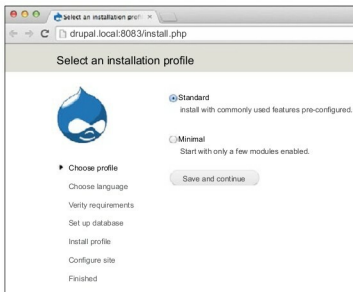


Figure 3: Drupal installation page

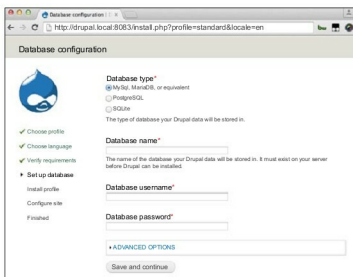


Figure 4: Database configuration

For a quick start, you can choose one of the preconfigured packages like WAMPServer, MAMP, XAMPP, or a LAMP-server package on a Linux based OS or Acquia's Dev Desktop.

Download Drupal

Go to <https://www.drupal.org/project/drupal> to download Drupal, which will be in the form of a .tar.gz or a .zip file. Extract it and place it into your Web server docroot. Create a virtual host that points to your docroot and assign a dev domain to the virtual host. Do not forget to update your IP tables to point this dev domain to your local host. Ensure that the .htaccess file and .gitignore files also get copied with the Drupal files.

Go into your MySQL administration and create a database for the Drupal site.

Creating settings.php and the files directory

Within the `sites/default/` directory, as seen in Figure 1, there will be a sample settings file `default.settings.php` which is what we will use to create our `settings.php`. Copy `default`.